

No. 37 Middle School

第37中学 · 历史

建校于1982年 — 遗址：港区44号（原砖窑与万人坑）

学校概况

始建于1982年，原址为废弃砖窑与万人坑。采用传统中式校园布局。两层红砖主楼以大礼堂为中心，教室向两侧延伸。主楼前为水泥操场，四周环绕香樟树。东侧尽头为理化实验室，西侧拐角为广播站。二楼以上为铁链封闭的天台，仅西侧楼梯可达。90年代初，为追求高考升学率，推行极端高压管理。





高压管理

全封闭管理，严禁外出。5:30起床早读，23:30熄灯。熄灯后必须用手电筒复习。违纪重罚，体罚常态化。竞争压抑，成绩至上。校园内弥漫消毒水与霉味。



1993年集体失踪事件

高考前夕，整届高三学生（约40人）在深夜集体失踪。次日早晨，班主任死于办公室，现场无挣扎痕迹。警方调查无果，恐慌蔓延。学校随即被封锁，永久关闭。



时间线

1982年	1985年	1990年	1993年6月6日	1993年6月7日	1993年6月8日后
建校 在原砖窑与万人坑遗址上建校	校园扩建 增建实验室、广播站、宿舍楼	实施高压管理 推行极端作息与升学率政策	集体失踪 整届高三学生神秘消失	老师死亡 班主任陈志强死于办公室	学校封闭 警方调查无果 学校永久封锁

港区教育局文件

关于第37中学实施全封闭管理的批复

1990年7月12日

作息时间表

05:30	起床早读
07:00	早餐
07:30	第一节课
12:00	午餐
12:30	午休（禁止睡觉）
13:00	下午课程
18:00	晚餐
18:30	晚自习
23:30	熄灯（后用手电复习）

处分通报

高三(3)班 王某某
夜间讲话，影响他人学习。记大过一次，罚站三小时并在全校通报批评。

1992年7月5日

第37中学 永久封闭

港区人民政府
1993年6月15日

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“Well, they all said that after surviving these three years and getting into a good university, everything would be over. Until that late night, when I heard Li Hongmei's ethereal whisper through the static - ‘If you can't get into a good university, you are just a good-for-nothing.’

That's when it struck me: the dismissal bell of No. 37 Middle School never truly stopped ringing. And as you open this yellowed archive, hold your breath, because the red pen in the faculty office has already begun to mark...”

1. History

No. 37 Middle School was founded in 1982 at No. 44 Harbour District, on a site that was originally an abandoned brickworks and a mass grave. The school adopted an old Chinese campus layout. A two-story red-brick main building was centered around a grand auditorium, with classrooms extending to both sides. The concrete playground in front of the main building was surrounded by lush camphor trees. At the far end of the east side was the physics and chemistry lab, while around the corner on the west side was the broadcast station. Above the second floor sat a rooftop sealed off with iron chains, reachable only through a narrow stairwell in the west corner. In the early 1990s, in pursuit of higher university entrance rates, the school implemented an extremely high-pressure management system.

Under this severe, closed-off management, the school squeezed every second of the students' time to the absolute limit, with harsh punishments and suffocating competition filling the entire campus. Until the eve of the 1993 college entrance exams, years of accumulated resentment finally erupted: an entire graduating class vanished into thin air in the middle of the night, leaving behind only the cold corpse of their headteacher, who had dropped dead in the staff office the next morning. With a thorough police investigation yielding no results and panic spreading, the school was promptly shut down and permanently locked up.



2. Key Figures and Related Incidents

(1) Prominent Figures

Broadcaster: *Li Hongmei*

Born in 1972, Li Hongmei was the eldest child in the family. Li's father, Li Ping, worked at a local

post office, and Li's mother, Zhang Xiuying, was a Chinese teacher at the high school. According to her classmates, Li “was a good student who never spoke much. She seemed to have the typical shy girl kind of temperament, not close to anyone in particular”. In 1988, Li was selected by the Dean to be the school broadcaster after winning the Stella Student Prize for two consecutive semesters. Li died on May 4th, 1989, about one month before the National College Entrance Exam that year.

Li's body was found by a P.E. teacher who wanted to find some lost equipment in the broadcasting room on the morning of May 5th. The local police station received the call at around 5-6 a.m.

Headteacher: *Zhang Xiuying*

Born in 1950, Zhang Xiuying was the only daughter of a farmer's family. The detailed information of her original family is unknown, but there was hearsay at the school claiming that Ms. Zhang was an orphan at a very young age. Zhang Xiuying's employment at the high school started in 1972, the same year when her daughter, Li Hongmei, was born. Zhang was known for her strict pedagogical methods: she did not shy away from physical punishment when students failed to meet her expectations.

For a brief period of time in 1989, Zhang taught the class in which her daughter Li Hongmei was in. It was suspected that high peer pressure and family expectations were the cause of Li's death. After the death of her daughter, Zhang became even more strict with her students and devoted most of her time to teaching. An old colleague of Zhang quoted: “Sometimes it seemed like she could not let herself rest. We could tell that something painful awaited her the moment she drew away from work.”

The body was found by another Chinese teacher who shared an office with Zhang. At first, he thought she was just taking a nap on the desk - the scene of Zhang working overnight was not something strange to the teachers - and nobody realized that a dead woman was sitting in the room until three hours later, when a student came knocking on the door to see if Ms. Zhang was there. The body was stiff when found, and it took three adults to move it from the chair.

(2) Incidents

Incident 1: *The Midnight Bell of the Broadcast Room (The Li Hongmei Incident)*



On May 4, 1989, shortly before the National College Entrance Examination (Gaokao), the school broadcaster Li Hongmei hanged herself in the broadcast room using a jump rope. From then on, the locked broadcast room became a forbidden zone on campus.

Late at night, harsh static bursts would erupt from the abandoned loudspeakers, followed by a distorted, pitch-shifted dismissal bell. Shortly after, the faint sound of rope friction and a girl's suppressed sobbing would filter through the speakers. According to night-shift security guards, Li's past voice

recordings sometimes bled into the static, muttering, “If you can't get into a good university, you are just a good-for-nothing.” Any student who heard this whisper after late evening study sessions would find an old jump rope inside their desk the very next day.

Incident 2: Crimson Annotations in the Faculty Office (The Zhang Xiuying Incident)

Following her daughter's death, headteacher Zhang Xiuying directed a manic sense of control toward her students, ultimately dying of a sudden heart attack at her desk while working overnight. When the security found her, the body was completely rigid, and her hand was still clutching a red pen tightly.



After Zhang's death, strange occurrences began haunting the third-floor faculty office. In the dead of night, the rustling of paper and heavy thuds of a red pen knocking against the wooden desk resonated down the hallway, as if Zhang was still in her office, marking students' homework. Stranger still, anyone peeking through the keyhole at night would catch a glimpse of a rigid figure slowly turning her head, with an old photograph of Li Hongmei resting quietly on the corner of her desk.

3. The Eerie Top Floor

A narrow staircase leads up to the top floor of the school, which is covered in dust and filled with a choking, musty odor. In the corner lie a few tattered flowerpots and several stacks of yellowed old textbooks - some tied together with hemp rope, others scattered across the floor. A grayish-white cloth covered an old grand piano; several strings had snapped, a few keys were silent, and the vast majority were out of tune. If you placed your foot on the pedal, it would emit a strange, creaking, and



groaning sound. On the wall opposite the piano stood several storage cabinets; some were locked, while others had locks that appeared to have been pried open. Inside were class rosters listing the names of all students and teachers from every graduating class in the school's history, as well as negatives of each graduating class's graduation photos. The annual exam results posters were also piled here, one of which had been torn to shreds. There was a small window on the top floor, with several water stains and signs of someone having tried to climb up it. The floor had cracks, and one of the planks seemed loose; through it, you could hear the whooshing of the wind and rustling sounds.

4. Dormitory

No. 37 Middle School implemented a totally closed-off management system: the dormitory building is located at the northernmost end of the campus, right next to the abandoned brickworks. The dormitory building is a typical 1980s tube-shaped building, with red brick exterior walls and rusted, peeling iron railings. Meanwhile, the corridor is narrow and never sees sunlight all year round, and the air is always a mixture of disinfectant and musty smells.

Each dorm room is packed with eight girls, and the iron bunk beds are full to bursting. To squeeze every second of study time out of them, the school made students wake up at 5:30 AM for morning reading; after lights out at 11:30 PM, they had to continue revising in bed with flashlights. At the end of the corridor is the communal washroom, where the faucet never stops dripping and makes an irritating ticking sound.



In the 1993 mass disappearance incident, an entire floor of senior girls' dormitories (about 40 people) disappeared into thin air late at night. When the police arrived, the bedding on the beds was still messy, toothbrushes on the washstand were wet, and some flashlights were still on, but the people had vanished. Ever since then, the building has been sealed off completely. If you come late at night to this abandoned dormitory building, you will hear the uniform sound of pages turning from upstairs, occasionally mixed with extremely suppressed sobbing. Most eerily, from the crack of the door at the end of the corridor, a faint and flickering flashlight beam always shines through, as if someone is still staying up late studying there.

5. The Office

When first constructed in 1982, there was only one faculty and staff office in No. 37 Middle School. As the student number of the school expanded, No. 37 Middle School added offices to each floor of the teaching building.

In the 1990s, in the main building, there were two offices at each end of all the floors. Next to the physics and chemistry lab, the school also added a special office for lab instructors to process students' experiment results and to store experimental materials and related equipment.

A basic office in No. 37 Middle School contained twelve desks, standing in pairs against each other, shared by teachers of different subjects. The school provided equipment like air-conditioners, computers, and printers in the office. On one side of the wall, the school set up iron cabinets for educational materials

and archive management. Normally, the cabinet was used for storing records of students' basic information, grade reports, attendance sheets, and records of students' daily behavior within the school. The only usable telephones were set in the offices, and were used at scheduled times under the faculty or staff's supervision. Examination revealed that on the walls of some offices, there were some nails carved with words like "Want to go home".

After the incident of the headteacher, certain staff members claimed to witness several supernatural phenomena happening in the office. At the strong request of the faculty and staff, approximately half of the offices were abandoned. Members had to share the rest of the offices. It was recorded that some teachers complained about the congestion and demanded the construction of new offices, and some teachers were forced to work from home. Still, it was reported that in the 90s, complaints about missing office files and malfunctioning equipment reached a new high. One of the most severe complaints was that the office near the lab was damaged and spontaneously combusted when no one was around at night in 1993.